



OCTOBER 12-18, 2026

8

SONG 129 We Will Keep Enduring

You Can Win the Battle!

“We have a struggle, not against blood and flesh, but against . . . the wicked spirit forces in the heavenly places.”—[EPH. 6:12](#).

FOCUS

Always remember that true Christians are fighting against wicked

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2. What will we discuss in this article?

² In the preceding article, we considered how the Devil tries to undermine our trust in Jehovah God and in Jesus Christ. In this article, we will discuss two other tactics that Satan uses in his fight against us. He tries to break up our unity with our brothers and sisters. And he stirs up opposition in an attempt to distract or frighten us, hoping to stop us from carrying out the work Jehovah has given us to do.

SATAN TRIES TO DIVIDE US

3. In what way does Satan try to divide us?

³ Satan tries to cause division between us and our brothers and

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consumed with jealousy when he saw that David was more popular with the people than he was. As a result, Saul engaged in a prolonged campaign to kill David. ([1 Sam. 18:9-11](#)) It would have suited Satan's interests if David were killed. How so? At Jehovah's direction, David had already been anointed as the future king of Israel. ([1 Sam. 16:13](#)) Satan would have been delighted if that purpose failed. Imagine Satan watching with satisfaction as jealous Saul became obsessed with killing the man Jehovah had chosen to be the next king.



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⁵ Satan knows that our unity leads to Jehovah's blessing and support. ([Ps. 133:1](#)) Because Satan seeks to destroy that unity, he wants us to become jealous and envious of others, just as Saul was of David. Satan knows that if we become jealous of our brother or sister, it will be very difficult to show them love. ([Mark 12:30, 31](#)) If that were to happen, would Jehovah find our worship acceptable? The disciple James wrote in very strong terms about the danger of allowing a jealous spirit to develop in us.—**Read [James 3:14-16](#).**

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6. What do you learn from the example of Jonathan? (See also picture.)

⁶ When we stand together as a united brotherhood, we can avoid allowing jealousy and envy to take root in our heart. Consider the fine example of Jonathan, the son of Saul. Unlike his father, who was jealous of David, Jonathan told his young friend David that he had complete faith that Jehovah's purpose would succeed. "You will be king

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[4:25-27](#).) Deepen your love for your brothers and sisters. Keep a proper view of them. Despite being so different, we are all members of one body. ([1 Cor. 12:12](#)) Our fellow Christians stand beside us, fighting the same enemies we are fighting—Satan and the demons.—[1 Pet. 5:8, 9](#).

8. How should we react when a fellow Christian says or does something that hurts us?

8 When a fellow worshipper says or does something that hurts you, remember that you are just as imperfect as he is. If you work closely together with others, it is realistic to expect some friction to develop. ([Eccl. 7:20](#)) When that happens, follow the inspired counsel to put up with one another. And if someone hurts you, be quick to forgive. ([Col. 3:12-14](#)) Cooperate with Jehovah and Jesus in their purpose to keep our Christian family united.—[John 17:20, 21](#).

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10. How did Isaac respond to injustice?

10 Consider the example of Abraham's son Isaac. Envious of Isaac's prosperity, the Philistines, his neighbors, made a hostile move—they stopped up wells that Abraham's servants had dug. ([Gen. 26:12-18](#)) Water was very important in caring for families and livestock. So Isaac chose to move farther away and dig other wells. However, the Philistines claimed ownership of the water in that location too. This kind of injustice could have been discouraging. Yet, Isaac prevented the quarreling between his shepherds and the Philistines from escalating. How? By pursuing peace. He moved yet again, and Jehovah blessed him. ([Gen. 26:19-25](#)) When we face injustice, can we likewise respond with mildness and patience?

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11. How did Jesus react to the challenges he faced?

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([Luke 22:50, 51](#)) In all these instances, Jesus never allowed the challenges he faced to distract him or cause him to seek revenge.

12. According to [Matthew 5:43, 44](#), how should we treat those who oppose or persecute us?

¹² Similarly today, we face situations that could discourage us. Satan tries to keep us from carrying out the preaching work. Unbelieving family members or others may oppose or even persecute us. Yet, Jesus instructed us to love even those who persecute us. **(Read [Matthew 5:43, 44](#).)** This rules out responding with hostility when we suffer persecution. Rather, following Jesus' clear direction, we do our best to treat all men kindly, patiently, and respectfully even if they oppose us or our work.—[1 Cor. 13:4](#).

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13. Why should we respect governments even if they oppose us? (See also picture.)

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Will you resist the world's efforts to make you compromise your neutrality? (See paragraph 13)

14. What should we keep in mind about those who oppose God's people?

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15. Why is it unrealistic to try to correct all the injustices that we see or suffer today?

15 We would soon expend a lot of our time and energy if we tried to correct all the injustices that we see or suffer today. ([Eccl. 1:15](#)) Jehovah knows exactly what we are enduring. ([Ps. 37:18](#)) Very soon, his Kingdom will undo all the harm that Satan and his agents have caused. ([1 John 3:8; Rev. 21:5](#)) In the meantime, we must remain patient and show love for our neighbor. We should focus our time and energy on helping as many as possible to become Jehovah's friends. 13

WE CAN WIN THE BATTLE!

16. What will help us to win the battle against wicked spirit forces? (See also pictures.)

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We can win the battle against wicked spirit forces by promoting love and unity among our brothers and sisters (See paragraph 16)

17. What should we be determined to do?

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HOW WOULD YOU ANSWER?

- How does Satan try to break up our unity with our brothers and sisters?

- How does Satan try to discourage us from carrying out the Kingdom-preaching work?

- What convinces you that you can win the battle against the wicked spirit forces?

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